

ISAIAH V. VI. VII.

27 There is none weary nor stumbling among its men; it slumbereth not, it sleepeth not; not loosened is the girdle of its loins, not broken is the latchet of its shoes;

28 Whose arrows are sharpened, and all whose bows are bent; its horses' hoofs are hard like the flint, and its wheels like the whirlwind;

29 It hath a roar like the lioness, it roareth like the young lions: yea, it growleth, and layeth hold of the prey, and carrieth it safely off, with none to deliver.

30 And it will rage against them on that day like with the raging of the sea: and if one look unto the earth, behold, there is darkness, oppression,^a and the light is darkened through the darkness of its clouds.

CHAPTER VI.

1 ¶ In the year of king 'Uzziah's death I saw the Lord sitting upon a high and exalted throne, and his train filled the temple.

2 Seraphim were standing around him, each one had six wings; with two he covered his face, and with two he covered his feet, and with two did he fly.

3 And one called unto the other, and said, Holy, holy, holy is the LORD of hosts; the whole earth is full of his glory.

4 And the posts of the threshold shook at the voice of those that called aloud, and the house was filled with smoke.

5 And I said, Wo is me! for I am lost; because a man of unclean lips am I, and in the midst of a people of unclean lips do I dwell; for the King, the LORD of hosts have my eyes seen.

6 Then flew unto me one of the seraphim, and in his hand was a live coal,^c with the tongs had he taken it from off the altar:

7 And he touched therewith upon my mouth, and said, Lo, this hath touched thy lips; and thy iniquity is departed, and thy sin is forgiven.

8 And I heard the voice of the Lord, say-

^a i. e. The inimical nation, against Israel.

^b Sachs, "darkness of distress," otherwise this verse is rendered after him. Some translate, "moon and sun are rendered dark through its clouds;" making נֶחֱמָה the moon, or small luminary.

^c Sachs, "a glowing stone."

^d Philippon, "You shall hear, but not understand," &c.

^e After Rashi. Others, "Make obdurate," &c.; meaning, the perverseness of the people is so great that the

ing, Whom shall I send, and who will go for us? And I said, Here am I; send me.

9 And he said, Go, and say unto this people, Hear^a indeed, but understand not; and see indeed, but know not.

10 Obdurate^a will remain the heart of this people, and their ears will be heavy, and their eyes will be shut: so that they will not see with their eyes, nor hear with their ears, nor their hearts be understanding, so that they be converted, and healing be granted them.

11 And I said, How long, O Lord? And he said, Until that cities be left waste without an inhabitant, and houses without man, and the soil be made desolate as a wilderness.

12 And the LORD will have removed far away the men, and the depopulation be great in the midst of the land.

13 And should a tenth part thereof yet remain, it will again be swept away: (yet) like the terebinth and the oak, which, when they cast their leaves, retain their stems, so remaineth the holy seed, its^a stem.

CHAPTER VII.

1 ¶ And it came to pass in the days of Achaz the son of Jotham, the son of 'Uzziah, the king of Judah, that Rezin the king of Syria, and Pekach the son of Remalyahu, the king of Israel, went up toward Jerusalem to war against it; but were not able to make an attack upon it.

2 And it was told unto the house^a of David, saying, Syria is encamped with Ephraim; and his heart trembled, with the heart of his people, as the trees of the forest are shaken before the wind.

3 ¶ And the LORD said unto Isaiah, Go forth now to meet Achaz, thou with Shear-yashub thy son, to the end of the aqueduct of the upper pool, on the highway of the washer's^b field;

4 And thou shalt say unto him, Take heed, and be quiet; fear not, and let thy heart not become faint because of these two stumps of smoking firebrands, before the fierce

prophetic mission will only display the stronger their unworthiness. (See Exod. iii. 19; Deut. xxix. 3.)

^a Israel's. The deciduous tree casts its leaves in the autumn; still it dies not; with return of the spring a new foliage appears; so, though destruction comes after destruction over the godless, the holy seed, the truly pious, are the stem, the trunk of Israel's tree, sending out new branches and new leaves for ever.

^b i. e. The king.

^c Others, "fuller's field."